26900320 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2026

FIFTH SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCJMC300 - DOCUMENTARY PRODUCTION

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. Who is credited with coining the term 'documentary' in a 1926 review of Robert Flaherty's 'Moana'? [K] / [CO1]

   a). John Grierson b). Dziga Vertov

   c). Jean Rouch d). Michael Moore

2. Location analysis during a recce typically checks all of the following EXCEPT: [K] / [CO2]

   a). Availability of natural light b). Ambient noise levels

   c). Physical access for crew and equipment d). The final broadcast rating of the film

3. Which of the following best describes a 'mid shot' in documentary shooting? [K] / [CO3]

   a). A shot framing a subject from roughly the waist up b). An extreme close-up of an object

   c). A wide aerial view of a landscape d). A blurred, out-of-focus shot

4. Promotion planning for a documentary is generally initiated during which stage? [K] / [CO2]

   a). Post-production only
   b). Pre-production, alongside the shooting schedule
   c). Never, promotion is not planned
   d). Only after the film is broadcast

5. The process of aligning recorded audio precisely with the corresponding video footage is called: [K] / [CO3]

   a). Syncing audio and video
   b). Foley
   c). Audio dubbing
   d). Audio mastering

6. A microphone that clips onto a subject's clothing, commonly used for interviews, is called a: [K] / [CO2]

   a). Boom microphone
   b). Lavalier microphone
   c). Contact microphone
   d). Ribbon microphone

7. Which of the following is typically part of a documentary's basic equipment checklist? [K] / [CO2]

   a). Camera, tripod, and the microphone
   b). Ticket booking software only
   c). Marketing brochures
   d). Actor contracts only

8. A key purpose of colour grading in post-production is to: [K] / [CO3]

   a). Establish a consistent visual mood and style across the film
   b). Fix white balance errors and restore natural skin tones across shots
   c). Remove the background screen colors during chroma key compositing
   d). Standardize exposure levels to ensure the video signals are broadcast-legal

9. Before scripting begins, a documentary team typically conducts research to identify: [K] / [CO2]

   a). Editing software licenses only
   b). Key facts, characters, and the story's central thread
   c). Only the shooting schedule
   d). Only the sound mix

10. Post-production costs that should be included in a documentary budget include: [K] / [CO2]

a). Editing, sound design, and colour grading expenses

b). Only camera rental

c). Only crew travel

d). Only location permits

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **3** marks

11. Prepare a note on the Films Division of India. Briefly explain its role and contribution to the growth of documentary filmmaking in India. [An] / [CO1]

12. Explain the significance of the preliminary research phase in documentary filmmaking, and identify two common methods a filmmaker uses to gather information before shooting begins [A] / [CO2]

13. Explain why natural and artificial light sources equally need consideration during setup. [U] / [CO3]

14. Explain the primary purpose of a promotional strategy for a documentary film, and identify two different methods a production crew can use to generate public interest before its release. [S] / [CO2]

15. Explain the role of a release/consent form in documentary production. [U] / [CO2]

16. Differentiate between a fictional feature film screenplay and a pre-production documentary script, highlighting how their formats reflect the predictability of their stories. [U] / [CO2]

17. List out and explain the continuity elements that should be checked between shooting sessions on different days [U] / [CO3]

18. Explain the guiding factors in the choice of distribution platform for a documentary [U] / [CO3]

19. Describe why sound design is considered as important as visual editing in a documentary [U] / [CO3]

20. State the reaons for considering the reviewing of the footage carefully as a mandatory step before getting into editing. [An] / [CO3]

21. Substantiate the need for checking microphone audio levels during equipment setup with relevant points. [E] / [CO3]

22. List and explain the responsibilities that a Director of Photography (cinematographer) hold in a documentary shoot [An] / [CO2]

[3x10 = 30]

Part C

Essay Type Questions

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

23. Analyse how interviews and observational footage can create a balanced documentary sequence. [An] / [CO3]

24. Prepare a scripting strategy for a short awareness documentary on responsible social-media use. [C] / [CO2]

25. Explain the key aspects of equipment setup - camera, microphone, and lighting - required before a documentary shoot, with technical detail. [E] / [CO3]

26. A filmmaker wants viewers to question how documentary reality is constructed. Select the most appropriate mode and justify your selection with relevant points. [E] / [CO1]

[15x2 = 30]